



Off to Grandmother's House

Little Red stood outside of the small log cabin that she shared with her mother and stepfather. It was the coldest part of Winter and everything around her was covered in untouched snow.

Inside the cabin, her mother had just finished preparing two jars of food and a loaf of bread which she had placed inside of a basket. In a moment, she would open the door to the cabin and give this basket to Little Red so that she could deliver it to her grandmother who lived in another part of the woods.

It was a long walk to grandmother's house. It would take Little Red most of the afternoon and evening to travel there and back home again. It was about noon and the sun didn't stay out long at this time of year.

A moment later, the only entrance to the cabin behind her finally opened and her mother yelled for her to come take the basket.

Little Red turned around and ran back to where her mother stood, holding the door open. Her mother extended the basket towards Little Red and she reached out with her right arm to grab it out of her mother's hand. It was heavier than it had looked to her.

"Now, remember what I told you about walking through the woods alone, don't you?" her mother asked her with a serious look of concern.

Little Red nodded, trying not to roll her eyes at the question she'd been asked at least three times this morning.

Although her mother saw the nod, she pretended as if she hadn't and a moment later snapped:

"I said what did I tell you about walking through the woods alone, miss?"

Little Red sighed and felt the basket get heavier with the sarcasm of youth.

"I'm not to take so much as one step off the path and I must go directly to grandmother's house and straight back home again," she recited to appease her mother.

Her mother looked down at her and frowned.

"Do we remember why?" she asked.

Before waiting for a response from Little Red, she immediately followed it up with:

"There are dangerous and evil creatures deep in the forest. You must never speak to any of them, they can't be trusted."

Little Red nodded several times in acknowledgement. With one hand on her hip, the mother nodded back and motioned forward with her head to send Little Red on her way to grandmother's house.

Not taking anything her mother says too seriously, Little Red starts down the path through the woods to her grandmother's with the basket on one arm and a devious expression on her face.

As she begins the walk through the woods, she travels the clearly defined path through the snow that leads to her grandmother's. She thinks of all the boys she goes to school with in